REA PILLAI
shv3tm@virginia.edu | (434) 882 - 55827

EDUCATION

University of Virginia, College of Arts and Sciences, Charlottesville, VA

PhD in *Psychology* – Quantitative Psychology. ***August 2026- May 2032***

M.A. in *Psychology* – Quantitative Psychology (Concurrent degree with PhD)

B.A. in *Psychology* – Distinguished Majors Program ***August 2023- May 2026***
Minor in *Data Science*
GPA: 3.883/4.000
Honors: Distinguished Majors Program, 2025-26
Dean's List (all semesters)
Graduating in 3 years

RESEARCH PAPERS & BOOKS

1. Yang, J., **Pillai, R**., & Balkrishnan, R. (2026). Nonpharmacological interventions for cognitive decline and dementia-related outcomes in older Asian adults: A systematic review. Aging & Mental Health, 1–13. https://doi.org/10.1080/13607863.2026.2738058
2. Johri, K., **Pillai, R.,** Kulkarni, A., & Balkrishnan, R. (2025). Effects of sleep deprivation on the mental health of adolescents: A systematic review. *Sleep Science and Practice*, *9*(1), 9. https://doi.org/10.1186/s41606-025-00127-w
3. LeBlond, B., Christ, B. R., Ertman, B., Chapman, O., **Pillai, R.,** & Perrin, P. B. (2025). Using Machine Learning to Identify Educational Predictors of Career and Job Satisfaction in Adults with Disabilities. *Disabilities*. https://doi.org/10.3390/disabilities5020056
4. Watson, J. D., Silverman, A. L., Xia, B., **Pillai, R.,** Balkrishnan, R., Pierce, B. S., & Perrin, P. B. (2025). Development and validation of the telemedicine facilitators scale: A novel measure of telemedicine facilitators and use. *Journal of Telemedicine and Telecare*, 1357633X251333534. https://doi.org/10.1177/1357633X251333534
5. **Pillai, R.,** Patel, I., & Balkrishnan, R. (2023). Risk factors and strategies for prevention of depression, anxiety and eating disorders among adolescents during the coronavirus disease 2019 (COVID-19) pandemic: A review. *Global Health Journal*, *7*(2), 78–86. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.glohj.2023.04.004
6. **Editorial Assistant**: Balkrishnan, R. & Atherly, A. (in press). Research Methods for Healthcare: A Practical Guide. American College of Healthcare Executives.

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

1. **Pillai, R.,** Ertman, B., Christ, B. R., & Perrin, P. B. Functional disability and internalized ableism: A machine learning approach to multidimensional prediction. Manuscript submitted for publication.
2. Sanjeev, S., Ayyappan, P., **Pillai, R**., & Balkrishnan, R. Medication-related healthcare financial burden, outcomes, and policies among older patients in the US: A systematic literature review. Manuscript submitted for publication.
3. Mensah, M., Opoku, S., Selden, O., **Pillai, R**., & Balkrishnan, R. Period poverty and its determinants in Ghana: Analysis of nationally representative survey data. Manuscript submitted for publication.

REA PILLAI
shv3tm@virginia.edu | (434) 882 - 55827

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

1. **Pillai, R.,** Cho, Y. W., Henry, T. When your model ignores your breakup: How misclassified Exogenous Events impact Intensive Longitudinal Data.
2. Cho, Y. W., **Pillai, R**., Henry, T. Forecasting Health Behaviors with Deep Learning: A Simulation Study on Intensive Longitudinal Data.

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

Pillai, R., Ertman, B., & Perrin, P. B. (2026). *Functional disability and internalized ableism: A machine learning approach to multidimensional prediction*. L. Starling Reid Undergraduate Psychology Research Conference, University of Virginia, Charlottesville, VA, United States.

Pillai, R., Levin, J., Worden, M., Keltoumi, A., Jones, T. (2025). *Roots of Inclusivity: The Effect of Parental Perspectives and Disability Condition on Child Disability Attitudes*, The University of Virginia

Patel, I**., Pillai, R.,** Balkrishnan, R., & Coustasse, A. (2023). *The 2022 International Monkeypox Outbreak and Challenges Faced by the United States.* Third Virtual Marshall Business Research Conference, Marshall University.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Virginia, Department of Psychology, Charlottesville, VA ***September 2023 – Present***
Undergraduate Research Assistant -- Dr. Paul Perrin

- Systematized and managed data collection at Social Justice in Disability and Health Lab -- for a multi-center Traumatic Brain Injury study, *Reach-TBI*, in collaboration with the Department of Veterans Affairs, for 110+ veterans to evaluate the effects of tool-based interventions on caregivers of veterans with traumatic brain injury
- Co-authored and published 2 research papers within lab, regarding telemedicine and disability job satisfaction using machine learning
- Evaluated data collection procedures by analyzing for biases and ethical measures for all participants, within 12 individual scales

University of Virginia, Department of Psychology, Charlottesville, VA ***August 2025 – May 2026***
Distinguished Majors Program Thesis -- To be presented at the Reid Conference 2026

- Conducting independent research and modelling using Random Forest for 40-page senior thesis in the *Social Justice in Disability and Health Lab* under supervision of Dr. Paul Perrin
- Analyzing data regarding risk and protective factors of internalized ableism through machine learning to culminate in a thesis amongst 400+ participants

Virginia Tech, Psychology Department, Blacksburg, VA ***June 2025 – August 2025***
Undergraduate Research Assistant -- Dr. Adrienne Romer

- Formulated general psychopathology ('p') factor analysis in R for 800+ observations at *Spectrum of Psychopathology and Affective Neuroscience Lab*, highlighting baseline neural and behavioral measures of cognitive-effective control
- Re-coded 700+ variables from SPSS to R, streamlining data workflows and improving analysis efficiency while checking for multivariate correlations
- Conducted MRI scans and experimental projects deploying MATLAB and PsychoPy, supporting investigation of cognitive-affective control in adults and adolescents
- Recruited, interviewed, and screened participants virtually using RedCap to check for eligibility for both studies

REA PILLAI
shv3tm@virginia.edu | (434) 882 - 55827

- Led R training for 10 undergraduate research assistants, improving lab-wide coding proficiency.
- Created 4 novel versions of internal run-logs and refined 100+ participant eligibility records to improve workflow efficiency

Private Practice (Dr. Sanyogita Nadkarni), Pune, India ***June– August 2022***
Student Intern/Researcher

- Analyzed qualitative and quantitative patterns of child behavioral patterns in preschool settings (Pathshala, Baner) within 10 behavioral factors
- Facilitated interviews with 4 parents and staff members to gather historical data for the diagnosis
- Conducted data analysis and wrote a report to derive conclusions based on the observations

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Virginia, Department of Psychology, Charlottesville, VA ***January– May 2025***
Teaching Assistant – under Dr. Elise Clerkin

- Facilitated course instruction for 180+ students for Research Methods and Data Analysis I (taught by Dr. Elise Clerkin) by clarifying doubts, enhancing understanding, and engaging with course material
- Proctored 4 semester exams, ensuring academic integrity and adherence to the Honor Code

Bye Bye Anxiety, Remote ***August 2021 – February 2022***
Academic Tutor and Human Resources Leader

- Developed and delivered 80+ hours of course content regarding English as a second language for Indonesian students
- Connected over 400 students and volunteers internationally while serving on the HR team

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

University of Virginia (Student Council), Charlottesville, VA ***August 2025 – Present***
Co-Director, Safety and Wellness

- Oversee dispersion of 1000 units of Free STI Testing worth $40,000
- Outreach to reduce health disparities amongst racially underserved by reaching 700+ students.
- Orchestrating provision of free emergency contraception worth $5,000, subsidizing medical care for 500+ students
- Marketing healthcare programs, including Narcan Training and Drug Take-back Week, increasing wellness awareness among student body
- Spearheading collaboration with the Gift of Life to execute a semesterly bone marrow drive amongst the student body to increase the scope of the national registry

Wahoo Weekender Newsletter, Charlottesville, VA ***November 2024 – Present***
Co-Director

- Launched weekly 'Wahoo Weekender' newsletter in collaboration with Safety and Wellness and Peer Health educators, reaching 24,000+ community members and promoting alcohol-free events, boosting engagement and attendance on grounds

Humanitas Journal of Human Rights, Charlottesville, VA ***January 2025 – Present***
Editor

- Edited and fact-checked 2 student papers, providing feedback to enhance writing quality and ensuring adherence to journal and citation guidelines

REA PILLAI
shv3tm@virginia.edu | (434) 882 - 55827

Student Health Advisory Committee, Charlottesville, VA ***September 2025 – Present***
Committee Member

- Selected by U.Va. faculty and staff to serve on a university committee of 10 students, representing the student body, and facilitate communication between student groups and administration

The Cavalier Daily, Charlottesville, VA ***January 2024 – May 2025***
Arts and Entertainment Section, Staff Writer

- Bolstered student voices on grounds by writing and editing 7 articles, to highlight student-run events and organizations

The American Chamber of Commerce, Colombo, Sri Lanka ***July– August 2024***
Intern

- Facilitated communication amongst 350+ organizations for corporate social responsibility activities
- Reconstructed a filing system for 90+ organization invoices
- Spearheaded the development and presentation of 2 human resource initiatives through the Employee Wellness Plan and Daycare systems for staff members

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

- Technical Skills: R, Python, RedCap, MATLAB, SPSS, Microsoft Office
- Language Skills: English, Hindi, French
- Clubs/Extra-curriculars: The Jefferson Literary and Debating Society, Philosophy Club